ORIGINAL ENTRY · WALKTHROUGH

# Riverbend Bicycle Supply

Keeping the books for 2026-12-01 to 2026-12-15, on screen.

31 documents · 5 journals · 42 accounts · versions A, B, C

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Your instruction booklet covers the accounting. This covers the software: what each screen is for, which steps are yours, and the two things the app works out for itself.

> **Nothing here happens on its own.** Entries are written, postings are posted, checkpoints are asked. The ledgers and the trial balance are the only things the app derives, and it derives them from what you posted.

## The order of work

STEP 1

### Documents

Read each one and decide whether it is a transaction to record. **Record an entry** marks that decision; it does not write the entry. Where a document needs nothing, choose **No entry required** and say why. That reason is part of the work and it is marked.

STEP 2

### Journals

Pick the journal built for that kind of transaction, then enter the accounts and amounts.

STEP 3

### Post

Move the entries to the ledgers yourself, to the general ledger and to the subsidiary ledgers where a line names a customer or a supplier. Nothing posts itself.

STEP 4

### Ledgers

Derived from what you posted, so there is nothing to type. A balance that surprises you points at the entry or the posting behind it.

STEP 5

### Trial balance

Also derived. If the columns do not agree, something is unposted or an entry carries a figure it should not.

STEP 6

### Checkpoints

Test a figure you reached against the books you built.

STEP 7

### Submit

Hands the books in and makes them read-only. Handed in by accident? Your instructor can give them back.

# A worked example

This transaction is **not** one of your 31. It is here so every step can be shown in full without answering anything you are meant to judge yourself.

THE DOCUMENT

**Cheque 9001**, 3 December. Paid Marlow Window Cleaning $60.00 for cleaning the shop front.

## 1. On the document, say what it needs

It is a transaction, so choose **Record an entry**. That marks the decision and nothing more: no entry exists yet.

```
Documents › Cheque 9001
[ Record an entry ]  [ No entry required ]
```

## 2. Choose the journal

Money left the business by cheque, so it belongs in the **Cash Payments Journal**. Choosing the journal built for a transaction is part of what is marked.

## 3. Write the lines

Enter the accounts and the amounts. The app checks two mechanical things: that the entry balances, and that the journal has a column for each account you used. It says which of those failed and nothing else, because the accounts you chose are your judgement.

| Account | Debit | Credit |
|---|---|---|
| Some expense account, as you judge it | 60.00 | |
| 101 Cash | | 60.00 |

> **The app never names the account for you.** It is shown here as a blank on purpose; deciding it is the work.

## 4. Post it

Back in the journal, choose **Post to the general ledger**. Until you do, the entry sits in the journal and reaches no ledger and no trial balance. Where a line names a customer or a supplier, post it to the subsidiary ledger as well.

```
Journals › Cash Payments Journal
[ Post to the general ledger ]
```

### 5. Read the result

Cash in the general ledger is now $60.00 lower, and the trial balance has moved with it. You typed neither figure: both are worked out from the entry you posted.

## The journals, and what each is for

| Journal | Use it for |
|---|---|
| **Sales Journal** | Sales on account. Not cash sales. |
| **Purchases Journal** | Anything bought on account, from inventory to office supplies. |
| **Cash Receipts Journal** | Every receipt of money, including cash sales and payments from customers. |
| **Cash Payments Journal** | Every payment of money: cheques, remittances, payroll. |
| **General Journal** | Anything the four special journals have no column for. |

A special journal has named columns, and it will refuse a line it has no column for. That refusal is about the journal, not about the account: the general journal takes anything.

## Checkpoints

A checkpoint asks for one figure from your own books. Type what you reached and choose **Check**. It says whether your figure agrees with the books you built, and nothing about how you got there. Attempts are limited, so work it out before you try.

| # | It asks for |
|---|---|
| 1 | Accounts Receivable control balance at 15 December |
| 2 | Cash balance at 15 December |
| 3 | Accounts Payable control balance at 15 December |

## What the app refuses, and why

| You will see | It means |
|---|---|
| This entry does not balance | Debits and credits differ. Arithmetic, not judgement. |
| This journal has no column for that account | Either the account or the journal is not the one you want. Both are yours to decide. |
| These books are read-only | You submitted, or the deadline passed. Your instructor can give the books back. |

A refusal is always mechanical. The app never comments on the accounts you chose or the figures you entered, and it never reacts differently to a mistake it was built to expect.

## When you are stuck

Read the document again before changing an entry: most of what looks like a problem with the software is a detail on the paper, and the terms, the freight and the discount periods are all printed there. **Reference** in the workspace holds this company's chart of accounts. After that, ask your instructor, who can see where you are and what the app last refused.

> **Your figures are your own.** Riverbend Bicycle Supply comes in versions A, B, C, and they differ by design. A classmate's numbers will not match yours even where the method is identical.